

S05-02 - Short Rest Before the Storm

Player read-aloud

For a little while, the Old Sable gives you room to breathe.

Scene summary

The party takes a short rest while the Custodian prepares the ritual.

Visible choices

- Tend wounds
- Clear stress
- Repair armor
- Prepare together

Player questions

- During the short rest, who helps someone else without making a big deal of it?
- What do you prepare that is not a weapon?
- What fear do you admit before the ritual starts?

Raw source

- Id: S05-02
- Act: Act Five
- Title: Short Rest Before the Storm
- Beats: Roll/check Emotional beat
- Image: assets/scenes/S05-02-short-rest-before-the-storm.png
- Short: The party takes a short rest while the Custodian prepares the ritual.
- Long: This is the breath before the ordeal. Let characters tend wounds, prepare, or share one quiet line.
- Read: For a little while, the Old Sable gives you room to breathe.
- Gm: Ask each player how they prepare. Give them ownership of the battlefield.
- Entities: Open Vale? Ritual Site Whitefire Custodian Keystone Asset Old Sable Short Rest Khari Nix
- Choices: Tend wounds Clear stress Repair armor Prepare together
- Prompt: Adventurers resting around ritual clearing: repairing armor, tending wounds, checking weapons, while Custodian prepares runes around Keystone Asset; ominous calm; no monsters yet.
- Source Entities: Open Vale? Ritual Site Whitefire Custodian Keystone Asset
- Beat Codes: roll-check emotional-beat
- Slug: S05-02-short-rest-before-the-storm
- Act Title: The Ward Renewal
- Arc Role: Ordeal, ritual defense, and restoration
- Caption: The short rest is a pressure valve, not dead air.
- Image Alt: Short Rest Before the Storm scene art for The Ward Renewal.

- Image Prompt Used: Adventurers resting around ritual clearing: repairing armor, tending wounds, checking weapons, while Custodian prepares runes around Keystone Asset; ominous calm; no monsters yet. Do not include the Strixwolf Mother, strixwolf pups, wolves, owlbeats, or animal companions unless explicitly requested. No Strixwolf. No Bramble Union. Only Legacy Security Skeletons and Soul-Audit Wraiths as threats. 4:3 cinematic fantasy concept art, no visible text, no captions, no logos, no UI, no watermark.
- Long Storyboard: This is the breath before the ordeal. Let characters tend wounds, prepare, or share one quiet line. Run this scene as ordeal, ritual defense, and restoration: The short rest is a pressure valve, not dead air. Keep the camera close to practical choices, visible consequences, and the difference between ordinary people and the infrastructure pressing on them.
- Read Aloud: For a little while, the Old Sable gives you room to breathe.
- Gm Notes: Ask each player how they prepare. Give them ownership of the battlefield. Keep player-facing information actionable. Reveal systemic truth through objects, reactions, and consequences before naming it. Manufactured-threat lens: seed the contradiction, do not explain it. The surface goal stays simple and heroic.
- Sensory Details: hands shaking after being still moss damp through clothing the Keystone ticking like a second pulse
- Body Language: Players can show care through small prep The Custodian only sits if invited
- Sample Dialogue: Khari Nix Say what you need. Pride is heavy, and we are already carrying a stone.
- Checks: Any fitting trait Prepare, comfort, ward, scout, or confess. Easy Grant a small situational edge. 10 Cleanly resolve: Prepare, comfort, ward, scout, or confess. Add a concrete boon, extra clue, or improved position. Success, plus the player names one helpful detail or asks one follow-up question. Success, but the GM exposes a cost, ticks a countdown, or reveals a new pressure tied to Short Rest Before the Storm. The full goal slips, but the party still learns a useful truth or avoids the worst consequence. The GM makes a hard move that follows from the fiction and leaves the next choice visible. Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. On mixed or sliding results, reveal information in layers: visible fact, actionable clue, then systemic truth.
- Choices Consequences: Spend time on the Custodian She is steadier. Custodian and Ward Stability improve. Spend time on tactics Opening round improves. Less emotional payoff.
- Clues: Custodian composure She can be steadied. She has been doing this alone too long. Kindness changes how she enters the ritual.
- Loot: One named preparation boon One final question answered
- Payoff Flags: Custodian Trust Track Ward Stability Track
- Filters: act-five choice custodian-trust-track emotional-beat gm-only rollcheck the-ward-renewal ward-stability-track npc manufactured-threat guaranteed-earned
- Index: 19
- Player Questions: During the short rest, who helps someone else without making a big deal of it? What do you prepare that is not a weapon? What fear do you admit before the ritual starts?
- Relationship Prompts: Which PC quietly checks on someone else here? Who disagrees

about the right thing to do without breaking trust?

- Ownership Prompt: Name one detail in Short Rest Before the Storm that belongs to your character's point of view.
- Reveal Hooks: Loreborne or Knowledge-focused PCs can read the institutional layer. Wildborne/community-focused PCs can read local custom and ecological stress. Martial/security-focused PCs can read threat posture and custody logic. Magic-focused PCs can feel ward tone, soul-signal, or spell instability. Loreborne: spots older legal, heraldic, or ward-craft language under the branding. Underborne: notices service doors, hidden routes, and who built the thing nobody credits. Highborne: reads etiquette, class panic, and reputational risk. Ridgeborne: notices stonework, weight, pressure, and structural weakness. Wildborne: reads the land, animals, and local ecological stress. Elf/Ribbet/Human/Giant/Katari: invite one sensory or social detail from the player's heritage. Sorcerer/Rogue/Warrior/Guardian/Ranger: give each class one table-facing way to shine without changing the plot.
- Fear Spends: Spend Fear to tick the ritual countdown, expose the Custodian, activate ward backlash, or trigger Market Correction. Tick the Ritual Countdown the wrong direction or expose the Custodian. Trigger Market Correction, Pass-Through, Memory Delve, or Group Attack when fiction supports it.
- Conditional Notes: S05-02 hush_trust=high Hush sends one small protective charm or food bundle that can clear 1 Stress once.
- Story Scope: Perceived antagonist: the forest. True antagonist: the corporate lie about the forest. The players never confront it directly. They are meant to feel it by the end. Every act offers at least one guaranteed and one earned hint that the danger is manufactured and the forest is not the enemy. Soul-Audit Wraiths bear audit glyphs and say, "Unlicensed soul-resonance detected. Submit for audit." REFLAVOR GUARANTEED A defeated wraith leaves a Soulspire compliance tag or coil-credit token instead of natural remains. ADD GUARANTEED Wraiths ignore forest creatures and home only on ritual soul-magic. ADD EARNED Instinct Medium 15 A player can read the markings and name Soulspire without the GM naming it first. ADD EARNED Knowledge Medium 15 Optional flag: Legacy Skeletons carry scraps of old corporate credentials. FLAG SEED Instinct: target logic. Knowledge: read markings. ACT5 Act 5: Open Vale defense 200 2:40 to 3:20 3:20 countdown 8, skeletons, wraiths, Market Correction Lower the countdown start to 6; cap wraith reinforcements.
- Mechanics: The party is in Act Five pressure: The party takes a short rest while the Custodian prepares the ritual. Use Daggerheart Duality Dice as baseline. Use the listed Difficulty and outcome options when a roll matters. Keep trivial actions no-roll; roll only when uncertainty, cost, or danger is interesting. s05-02-use-the-short-rest-with-intention S05-02 Use the short rest with intention Use the short rest with intention Presence Finesse Knowledge Presence Finesse, Knowledge 10 Presence tends emotions; Finesse repairs gear; Knowledge prepares the field. The rest becomes bookkeeping instead of care before danger. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the

GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the...

- Roll Cards: s05-02-use-the-short-rest-with-intention S05-02 Use the short rest with intention Presence Finesse Knowledge Presence Finesse, Knowledge 10 Presence tends emotions; Finesse repairs gear; Knowledge prepares the field. The rest becomes bookkeeping instead of care before danger. Critical Success: best possible version of the action; gain Hope and clear 1 Stress. Add an extra benefit that follows from the fiction. Success with Hope: the PC gets what they wanted and gains Hope. Keep the position clean or generous. Success with Fear: the PC gets what they wanted, but the GM gains Fear and introduces a cost, complication, or pressure. Failure with Hope: the PC does not get the full result, but gains Hope and receives a useful thread, clue, or safer next option. Failure with Fear: the PC fails and the GM gains Fear. Make a hard move that follows from the fiction. The rest becomes bookkeeping instead of care before danger. Use a hard complication, lost time, worse position, GM Fear, or mark Stress. Apply an official condition only if the fiction and rules justify it. The attempt falls short, but a partial thread appears. Offer one clue, weak position, or...
- Conditions Hazards: No official condition unless a feature, hazard, or fictional position calls for Hidden, Restrained, or Vulnerable.
- Search Loot Clues: No fixed loot. Offer clue, texture, or hospitality only when the fiction supports it.
- No Roll Guidance: Do not call for a roll when the players have time, a clear method, and no meaningful pressure.
- Tv Mechanics Caption: Public cue: Short Rest Before the Storm asks what the party does, what it costs, and who is protected.
- Trait Variety Note: Primary traits in this scene: Finesse, Knowledge, Presence. If rolls drift toward Instinct/Presence, ask whether Agility, Strength, Finesse, or Knowledge better describes the action.
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